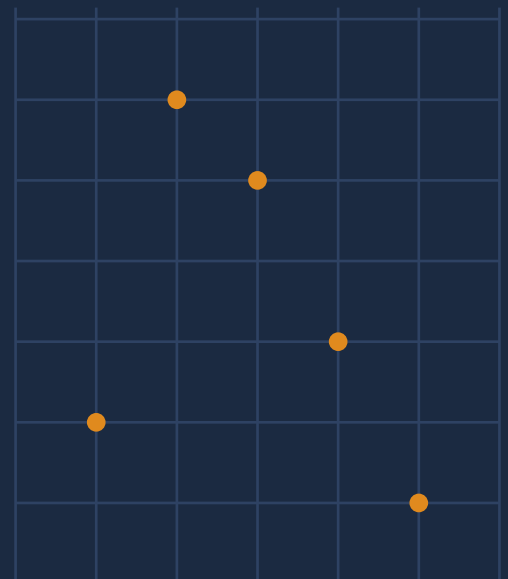

Business & Marketing Plan

Skelli-Sites

"Your brand, built to sell."

Prepared by Mike Haddon, Founder
Tyler, Texas
September 2026
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PART I

The Business Plan

What we are building, who it serves, the market we are entering and how the company will run day to day.

OVERVIEW

4. Executive Summary

Skelli-Sites builds, launches and runs branded online stores for small businesses and dropshippers, so owners can sell under their own brand without managing any technology.

The opportunity. Small businesses and new dropshipping sellers can pick from plenty of tools. What they lack is time, technical skill and brand-building know-how. DIY builders such as Shopify and Wix hand them a blank template and an app store. Agencies charge \$5,000 to \$25,000 or more. Freelance marketplaces are inconsistent. Many dropshipping stores fail because they look generic, earn little trust and convert poorly.

The solution. Skelli-Sites is a custom-built, full-stack eCommerce platform (React, Node.js/Express, MySQL, AWS). It already includes a storefront, persistent cart, Square and PayPal checkout, saved payment methods, and an admin panel for products, orders, customers and transactions. On top of the platform we sell a **done-for-you** service. We design the brand, build and stock the store, connect payments and fulfillment, launch it, then keep it running and growing with hosting, maintenance and ad management for a monthly fee.

Target customers. (1) Local and regional small businesses in Tyler and East Texas, such as boutiques, makers, specialty food, salons with retail and service businesses adding products. (2) Online-first dropshipping and print-on-demand entrepreneurs anywhere in the U.S. who want a real brand instead of a generic store.

Business model. A one-time implementation fee (\$1,500 to \$6,500+, averaging about \$2,950) plus a monthly plan (\$149 to \$899, averaging about \$362) that covers hosting, maintenance, support and, on higher tiers, ad and email marketing management. Clients pay their ad spend directly to the ad platforms.

Where we are. The MVP is deployed on AWS EC2 and is being polished. The platform should be production-complete within about a month (target: late October 2026). The company is self-funded by the founder.

Financial highlights (expected case)

\$120,708 Year 1 revenue	\$344,371 Year 2 revenue	\$542,580 Year 3 revenue	Month 4 Startup capital recovered*
24 Clients launched, Year 1	90 Active clients, end Year 3	\$32,381 Monthly recurring revenue, end Year 3	\$6,000 Startup costs

*The month cumulative cash first exceeds the founder's starting contribution. Monthly plans alone cover the Year 1 fixed cost base, including the owner's draw, from about Month 9.

Funding. The founder is contributing \$10,000 to cover startup costs and a cash reserve. At the modeled pace the business funds itself from early revenue. Outside funding (an SBA microloan or a small angel round) is optional and would only speed up hiring and marketing (Section 27).

WHO WE ARE

5. Company Description

Mission

To give every small business and independent seller a professional, trustworthy brand and online store, built for them, so they can focus on their products and customers instead of technology.

Vision

Become the go-to eCommerce launch partner in East Texas within three years, and a recognized national brand-building service for dropshipping and print-on-demand entrepreneurs.

Core values

Value	What it means in practice
Ownership for the client	Clients own their brand, domain, customer list and content. No lock-in on their data.
Done means done	We deliver working stores, not to-do lists. Launch day includes live payments and a first marketing push.
Plain-English partnership	No jargon. Monthly reports explain what happened, why, and what we will do next.
Security by default	Tokenized payments, JWT authentication, role-based admin access, HTTPS and regular backups.
Local first, online everywhere	Face-to-face service in Tyler, with remote service for clients across the U.S.

Business concept

The name **Skelli-Sites** comes from the product itself: a reusable **eCommerce “skeleton”**, a solid, tested codebase that already handles the hard, repetitive parts of online selling (catalog, cart, checkout, payments, customers, orders and admin). For each client we add a custom brand “skin” and fill it with their products. Because the core is reused, we can deliver a custom-looking store faster and cheaper than an agency building from scratch. Because it is our own code, we can customize it far more than a hosted-template platform allows.

Company facts

Item	Detail
Company name	Skelli-Sites
Legal entity	Recommended: Skelli-Sites LLC (Texas Limited Liability Company)
Location	Tyler, Texas (Smith County). Home-based to start; coworking space planned for Year 3
Owner	Mike Haddon, Founder & Lead Developer (100%)
Contact	haddon.mike2@outlook.com · 903-275-0013
Stage	Pre-revenue. MVP deployed on AWS; product polish underway; production launch targeted late October 2026

Item	Detail
Industry	eCommerce development & digital marketing services (NAICS 541511 Custom Computer Programming; 541613 Marketing Consulting)
Funding	Self-funded; may pursue SBA microloan or angel funding for growth

LEGAL TO-DO: Texas LLC formation (Form 205) costs \$300 with the Secretary of State. If the brand name differs from the LLC name, file an Assumed Name Certificate. Check City of Tyler rules on home-based businesses. Texas has no personal income tax. Confirm franchise-tax and sales-tax obligations with a CPA (see Section 28).

Milestones reached

- Full-stack platform built: React 19 storefront, Node.js/Express 5 API, MySQL via Sequelize ORM.
- Payments: Square Web Payments (card) and PayPal integrations, with payment create, complete, refund and list endpoints.
- Accounts & security: registration and login, JWT access and refresh tokens, protected admin routes, role-based admin access.
- Admin panel with Products, Orders, Customers and Transactions management, including order status tracking.
- Cart persistence for guests and logged-in users (local storage plus server sync), merged when a guest logs in.
- Checkout conveniences: saved cards, default card, and geolocation-assisted address prefill.
- Donation-type products supported in the data model (useful for nonprofit and fundraising clients).
- MVP deployed to Amazon EC2. Responsive navigation reworked for mobile.

WHY THIS BUSINESS SHOULD EXIST

6. Problem & Solution

The problems our customers face

Pain point	Who feels it	What it costs them
No time or technical skill to build a store	Local owners already working full time in the business	Months of delay; online sales never start
Generic, untrustworthy-looking stores	New dropshippers using default themes	Low conversion; customers leave before buying
Too many tools and apps to stitch together	Everyone on DIY platforms	Mounting app subscriptions, broken integrations, wasted evenings
No brand: logo, voice or story	First-time founders	Competing on price alone against Amazon and Temu
Marketing is a black box	Owners who launch and then hear crickets	Wasted ad spend; no idea what is working
Agencies are too expensive	Businesses under ~\$500k in revenue	\$5k to \$25k+ quotes put a real store out of reach

Our solution

Problem	How Skelli-Sites solves it
No time or skill	Done-for-you build: we handle design, setup, product entry, payments and launch.
Generic stores	Every store starts with a brand kit (logo, palette, typography, voice) and a custom theme on our platform.
Tool sprawl	One platform, one monthly bill: hosting, security, updates, backups and support included.
No brand	Brand discovery workshop and positioning statement included in Brand and Signature tiers.
Marketing black box	Growth and Scale plans include ad management and plain-English monthly reports.
Agency pricing	The reusable platform core lets us charge \$1,500 to \$6,500 for work agencies price at 3 to 5 times that.

WHAT WE SELL

7. Products & Services

The platform (what every client gets)

Capability	Status	Client benefit
Branded storefront, product catalog, categories, product pages	Built	A professional store that looks like their brand
Persistent shopping cart (guest and signed-in)	Built	Fewer abandoned carts
Card checkout via Square; PayPal checkout	Built	Trusted payment options; tokenized, PCI-friendly
Customer accounts, saved cards, address prefill	Built	Faster repeat purchases
Admin panel: products, inventory, orders, customers, transactions	Built	Run the business from one dashboard
Refunds and payment management	Built	Handle customer service without leaving the admin
Donation products	Built (polishing)	Fundraising for nonprofits, churches and schools
HTTPS and custom domain	In progress	Security, SEO and trust
Buy-now-pay-later (Klarna, Afterpay)	Planned	Higher average order value
Product reviews	Planned (admin-ready)	Social proof
Shipping and logistics integration, order confirmation emails	Planned	Automated fulfillment and customer updates
Dropship supplier integrations (product import and order routing)	Planned	Hands-off fulfillment for dropshippers
Analytics dashboard (sales, traffic, conversion)	Planned	Clear view of performance

Implementation packages (one-time)

	Launch — \$1,500	Brand — \$3,500	Signature — \$6,500+
Best for	Dropshippers and simple catalogs	Small businesses building a real brand	Established businesses; complex catalogs
Brand identity	Logo refresh or simple wordmark, color palette	Full brand kit: logo, palette, fonts, voice guide	Brand strategy workshop + full kit + brand story
Store design	Themed platform template	Custom-styled theme	Fully custom design, custom features
Products loaded	Up to 50	Up to 250	Unlimited / bulk import
Content	Core pages (Home, About, FAQ, Policies)	Core pages + product copywriting (top 25)	All copy + blog setup + 3 launch articles

	Launch — \$1,500	Brand — \$3,500	Signature — \$6,500+
Integrations	Square or PayPal	Square + PayPal, email capture	All payments, BNPL, shipping, supplier connections
SEO	Basic on-page	On-page + Google Business Profile	Full technical SEO + local SEO
Launch support	Launch checklist, 1 training call	Launch campaign setup, 2 training calls	Launch campaign + 30 days hands-on support
Timeline	~2 weeks	~3 to 4 weeks	~5 to 8 weeks

Monthly plans (recurring)

	Care — \$149/mo	Growth — \$399/mo	Scale — \$899/mo
Hosting, SSL, backups, security updates	Included	Included	Included
Support	Email, 2-business-day response	Priority, 1 business day	Priority + monthly strategy call
Content / product updates	Up to 1 hr/mo	Up to 3 hrs/mo	Up to 8 hrs/mo
Ad management (client pays ad spend)	—	1 channel (Meta or Google), up to \$1,500/mo spend	Multi-channel, up to \$5,000/mo spend
Email marketing	—	1 campaign/mo	Automated flows + 2 campaigns/mo
Reporting	Quarterly uptime report	Monthly performance report	Monthly report + conversion optimization

PRICING POLICY: Client ad spend above the plan limit carries a management fee of 12% of monthly spend. Growth and Scale plans have a 6-month minimum term. Package contents and prices are reviewed every 6 months.

Add-on services (à la carte)

Add-on	Price
Product photography (Tyler area) / AI-assisted product image editing	\$25 to \$40 per product
Additional product uploads beyond package	\$5 per product
Custom feature development	\$85/hour
Logo and brand kit (standalone)	\$500 to \$1,200
Copywriting: product descriptions / blog articles	\$20 per product / \$150 per article
Social media profile setup and branding	\$300
Store migration from Shopify, Wix or Etsy	\$500+

Product roadmap

Timeframe	Platform milestones
Oct 2026	Production launch: HTTPS + custom domains, production payment keys, cart-persistence fix on deployed build, image assets
Nov 2026 to Jan 2027	Order confirmation emails, shipping-rate and label integration, account management page, reviews
Feb to Apr 2027	Klarna/Afterpay, dropship supplier import (CSV + API), per-client theming system to cut build time
May to Oct 2027	Client analytics dashboard, abandoned-cart emails, SEO toolkit, automated multi-client deployments
Year 2	Multi-tenant architecture (many stores, one codebase), print-on-demand integrations, client self-service editor
Year 3	Template marketplace, optional lower-cost DIY tier, partner/reseller program for other agencies

WHO BUYS AND HOW MANY

8. Market Analysis

Industry overview

eCommerce keeps taking share from physical retail. U.S. retail eCommerce sales reached **\$340.2 billion in the second quarter of 2026**, about \$1.3 trillion a year, and made up **17.1% of total retail sales**, up from 16.9% in the first quarter (U.S. Census Bureau). Dropshipping, which lets a seller list products without holding inventory, is one of the fastest-growing ways new sellers enter eCommerce. Research firms size it in the hundreds of billions of dollars worldwide, with double-digit annual growth.

Three trends matter most to us:

- **Brand over product.** Marketplaces such as Amazon, Temu and TikTok Shop make generic products cheap and everywhere. Independent sellers survive by building a brand that customers trust and come back to.
- **Owner time is scarce.** Small business owners say lack of time is a leading barrier to going digital. They increasingly buy outcomes (“a working store”) instead of tools.
- **AI lowers build cost but raises the quality bar.** Generic AI-built stores are everywhere. Human-led branding and strategy stand out more, while AI tools let a small team deliver faster.

SOURCES: U.S. Census Bureau, Quarterly Retail E-Commerce Sales, 2nd Quarter 2026; U.S. SBA Office of Advocacy, 2025 Small Business Profiles; Federal Reserve (FRED) Tyler MSA population series. Full list in Appendix D.

Market sizing (TAM / SAM / SOM)

Layer	Definition	Estimate	Basis
TAM	U.S. small businesses and online sellers that could pay for eCommerce build and management services	~\$10B+/yr	36.2M U.S. small businesses (SBA, 2025); millions of active online sellers; web design and digital agency spend
SAM	Very small businesses (<\$1M revenue) and new/early dropshippers that want done-for-you service at our price point, reachable through our channels	~\$300M to \$500M/yr	~2% of U.S. small businesses x ~\$6,000 first-year spend
SOM (3-yr)	What we can realistically win: East Texas local plus online-sourced dropshippers	~\$542,580/yr by Year 3	~90 active clients (expected case)

Local market: Tyler & East Texas

- The Tyler metro area (Smith County) has about 250,000 residents (Federal Reserve/Census estimate, 2025). Tyler is a regional retail, medical and education hub, drawing shoppers from a much larger East Texas area, commonly estimated at over 1 million people.
- Its retail base is full of independent boutiques, gift shops, specialty foods, western and outdoor stores, and makers, many with thin or no online sales.
- Local business networks such as the Tyler Area Chamber of Commerce, Tyler Economic Development Council, Small Business Development Center (SBDC) programs, UT Tyler and Tyler Junior College give us direct, low-cost access to owners.

- Few local competitors specialize in eCommerce. Most local web shops build brochure sites on WordPress or Wix.

Customer segments & personas

	Persona A: "Main Street Maria"	Persona B: "Side-Hustle Sam"	Persona C: "Growing Grace"
Who	Owns a Tyler boutique or gift shop, 35 to 55, 1 to 5 employees	Aspiring dropshipper, 22 to 40, has a full-time job, anywhere in the U.S.	Runs a maker or specialty-food brand doing \$100k to \$1M, sells on Etsy or at markets
Goal	Sell online to regulars and tourists; compete with big-box stores	Launch a real brand and reach first \$1k/mo in profit	Own their channel; stop paying marketplace fees; scale
Pain	No time; tried Wix once and gave up; distrusts "tech people"	Overwhelmed by courses; generic store isn't converting	Outgrew Etsy; needs custom features and better marketing
Where to reach	Chamber events, in person, Facebook, local referrals	TikTok, YouTube, Reddit, Discord, Google search	Instagram, LinkedIn, Google search, craft and food networks
Likely package	Brand + Care or Growth	Launch + Care, upgrading to Growth	Signature + Growth or Scale
Buying trigger	Holiday season; a competitor launches online	Watching a success story; payday	Marketplace fee increase; hitting capacity

Customer needs & buying behavior

- **Trust decides the sale.** Local owners buy from people they have met. Online buyers rely on portfolios, reviews and demos.
- **Price anchoring.** They compare against \$39/month Shopify ("cheap") and \$10k agencies ("too expensive"). We sit in between and need to show clear value.
- **Seasonality.** Demand peaks in August to October (before the holidays) and January to March (New Year goals, tax refunds).
- **Decision process.** One decision-maker, a 1 to 4 week sales cycle, and a free consultation is expected.

WHO ELSE WINS THESE CUSTOMERS

9. Competitive Analysis

Competitor landscape

Competitor type	Examples	Typical cost	Strengths	Weaknesses vs. us
DIY hosted platforms	Shopify, Wix, Squarespace, BigCommerce	~\$30 to \$300/mo + apps + fees	Huge ecosystems, trusted brands, cheap to start	Owner does all the work; apps pile up; generic results
Open-source DIY	WooCommerce (WordPress)	Free core + hosting + plugins	Flexible, large community	Technical upkeep, security and plugin conflicts
Turnkey dropship store sellers	Pre-built "store in a box" vendors	~\$50 to \$500 one-time	Very cheap and fast	Cookie-cutter stores, no brand, poor support
Freelance marketplaces	Upwork, Fiverr	~\$200 to \$3,000	Cheap, lots of choice	Inconsistent quality; no ongoing management
eCommerce & digital agencies	Shopify Partner agencies; regional agencies	\$5k to \$25k+ build; \$1k to \$5k/mo retainer	Full service, experienced teams	Too expensive for our segments; slow
Local web designers (Tyler)	Small local studios and freelancers	\$1k to \$5k brochure sites	Local relationships	Rarely eCommerce specialists; little ad or brand strategy

PRICING BASIS: Competitor pricing as of September 2026. For example, Shopify Basic is \$39/month billed monthly or \$29/month billed yearly, before apps, themes and transaction fees. Agency and freelancer ranges are typical market quotes.

Comparison matrix

Factor	Skelli-Sites	Shopify (DIY)	Freelancer	Agency
Done-for-you build	Yes	—	Yes	Yes
Brand identity included	Yes	—	Partial	Yes
Ongoing management & ads	Yes	—	—	Yes
Custom features without app fees	Yes	Partial	Partial	Yes
Local, in-person service (Tyler)	Yes	—	—	Partial
First-year cost (typical)	\$4.5k to \$8k	\$1k to \$3k + your time	\$1k to \$4k	\$15k to \$50k
Mature app ecosystem	—	Yes	Partial	Yes
Proven at massive scale	Partial	Yes	—	Yes

SWOT analysis

STRENGTHS	WEAKNESSES
• Owned, custom full-stack platform, no licensing fees • Working MVP with payments and admin already built • Low overhead; self-funded; home-based • Done-for-you plus recurring model gives predictable revenue • Founder is both builder and service provider: fast, personal	• Solo founder: capacity and key-person risk • New brand with no portfolio or case studies yet • Platform lacks the app ecosystem of Shopify • Company is responsible for security, uptime and PCI scope • Limited marketing budget in Year 1
OPPORTUNITIES	THREATS
• Under-served East Texas small-business market • Dropshippers want a brand, not just a store • Recurring upsell from Care to Growth to Scale • Nonprofit and church donation stores (feature already built) • Partnerships: SBDC, Chamber, accountants, photographers • AI tools cut build time and cost	• DIY platforms keep adding AI site builders • Price competition from offshore freelancers • Economic downturn cuts small-business spending • Payment-processor or ad-platform policy changes • Security breach or outage harming client trust

Competitive advantage & unique value proposition

“A custom-branded online store, built and run for you, for less than an agency and with far less work than doing it yourself.”

- **Platform ownership:** the reusable core cuts delivery time and cost, and we are not paying another platform's margins.
- **Brand-first process:** every build starts with brand identity, which most DIY tools and freelancers skip.
- **One accountable partner:** build, hosting, support and marketing under one roof and one invoice.
- **Local presence:** a Tyler-based founder who meets clients in person, which is rare among eCommerce specialists.

HOW WE MAKE MONEY

10. Business Model & Revenue Streams

Revenue streams

Stream	How it's charged	Share of Year 1 revenue*
Implementation fees	One-time; 50% deposit to start, 50% at launch	59%
Monthly plans (MRR)	Monthly subscription via card on file; 6-month minimum on Growth and Scale	34%
Add-on services	Quoted per project / hourly	7%
Ad-management overage	12% of client ad spend above plan limit	Upside, not modeled

*Expected case. The share from recurring revenue rises every year: by Year 3 monthly plans are 60% of revenue.

Pricing strategy

- **Value-based, with an anchor in the middle.** The Brand package (\$3,500) is the recommended option. Launch gives a lower entry point and Signature makes Brand look reasonable.
- **Recurring revenue is the engine.** Implementation fees fund growth in Year 1. Monthly plans build long-term value and make cash flow predictable.
- **Founding-client offer.** The first 5 clients get 30% off implementation in exchange for a testimonial, a case study and permission to use their store in the portfolio.
- **Price review** every 6 months, based on delivery hours per package and close rates.

Unit economics (expected case assumptions)

Metric	Value	How calculated
Average implementation fee	\$2,950	Weighted by package mix (50% Launch / 35% Brand / 15% Signature)
Average monthly plan (ARPA)	\$362	Weighted by plan mix (45% Care / 40% Growth / 15% Scale)
Monthly churn / average client life	3% / ~33 months	Assumption; industry retainers see 2% to 5%
Gross margin on monthly plans	89%	After hosting/tools (~\$30/client) and 3% card processing
Customer lifetime value (LTV), gross profit	\$12,812	Setup gross profit + monthly gross profit x lifetime
Customer acquisition cost (CAC), Year 1	\$562	Year 1 marketing budget (\$13,500) / clients won
LTV : CAC ratio	23 : 1	Healthy is 3:1 or better. The ratio is high because Year 1 relies on referrals and networking
Payback period	Immediate	The 50% implementation deposit covers CAC on day one

CAVEAT: CAC excludes the founder's own sales time. Once paid ads become the main channel, expect CAC of \$400 to \$900 per client and keep LTV:CAC above 3:1.

HOW THE WORK GETS DONE

11. Operations Plan

Technology stack

Layer	Technology	Notes
Frontend	React 19, React Router 7, React-Bootstrap 5, Lucide icons	Responsive storefront and admin panel
Backend / API	Node.js, Express 5, REST endpoints	Products, orders, customers, transactions, cart, payments, auth
Database	MySQL with Sequelize ORM	Models: users, customers, products, orders, transactions, IP history
Payments	Square Web Payments SDK, PayPal JS SDK	Card tokenization keeps raw card data off our servers (lower PCI scope)
Auth & security	JWT access and refresh tokens, bcrypt password hashing, cookie-based sessions	Role-based admin access
Hosting	Amazon Web Services (EC2 today)	Plan: managed database (RDS), automated backups, HTTPS via load balancer or Let's Encrypt
Planned	Klarna/Afterpay, shipping APIs, transactional email, dropship supplier APIs	See product roadmap (Section 7)

Client delivery workflow

Step	Stage	Activities	Time (Brand pkg)
1	Discovery call (free)	Goals, products, budget, fit check; send proposal within 48 hours	30 to 60 min
2	Contract & deposit	E-signed statement of work (SOW); 50% deposit via invoice; client-onboarding form	1 day
3	Brand workshop	Audience, positioning, voice, visual direction; deliver brand kit	Week 1
4	Build	Deploy client instance, apply theme, configure payments, load products, write copy	Weeks 1 to 3
5	Review	Client review on a staging link; up to 2 revision rounds	Week 3
6	Launch	Domain and HTTPS go-live, test orders, analytics, launch email and social posts	Week 4
7	Training & handoff	Recorded admin-panel walkthrough; collect final 50%; start monthly plan	Week 4
8	Ongoing care	Monitoring, updates, support tickets, monthly report, quarterly growth review	Monthly

Supplier & partner relationships

- **Payments:** Square and PayPal (live), with Klarna and Afterpay planned. Each client gets their *own* merchant account, so funds go directly to them.
- **Dropship and print-on-demand suppliers** (planned integrations): candidates include CJdropshipping, Spocket, AutoDS, Printful, and U.S.-based wholesale suppliers. Partner-program status to be evaluated.
- **Freelance bench:** product photographer, copywriter and graphic designer on per-project rates (budgeted at 25% of implementation fees).
- **Referral partners:** bookkeepers, CPAs, business bankers, Tyler SBDC advisors and commercial photographers.

Customer support model

Channel	Care	Growth	Scale
Email / ticket portal	2 business days	1 business day	Same business day
Phone / video call	Scheduled	Scheduled	Direct line + monthly call
Site-down emergencies	4-hour response, 24/7	4-hour response, 24/7	1-hour response, 24/7

Key tools & vendors

- GitHub (source control, CI), AWS (hosting), uptime monitoring and error tracking (e.g., UptimeRobot, Sentry)
- CRM and proposals (e.g., HubSpot free tier), e-signatures, invoicing and recurring billing (e.g., Square Invoices or Stripe Billing)
- Bookkeeping (e.g., QuickBooks or Wave), project management (Trello, Notion or ClickUp), design (Figma, Canva)
- Email marketing (e.g., Mailchimp or Klaviyo), scheduling (Calendly), password manager for client credentials

OPS PRIORITY: The current codebase deploys one store per instance. Until the Year 2 multi-tenant rebuild, create a scripted per-client deployment (infrastructure-as-code or a Docker image) so each new client takes minutes to set up, not days. This is the biggest lever on delivery capacity.

THE TEAM

12. Management & Organization

Founder

Mike Haddon

Founder, Lead Developer & Client Strategist

Full-stack developer who designed and built the Skelli-Sites platform end to end: the React storefront, the Node.js/Express API, the MySQL data model, the Square and PayPal payment integrations, authentication, and the admin panel for products, orders, customers and transactions. The working, deployed platform is the clearest evidence of what the founder can deliver, and it is the foundation every client store is built on.

Responsibilities (Year 1): sales and discovery calls, brand workshops, development and deployment, client support, marketing, and administration.

Hiring plan

When	Role	Type	Why
Year 1 (as needed)	Photographer, copywriter, designer	Freelance, per project	Keeps founder focused on building and selling
Month 13	Client support / virtual assistant	Part-time contractor	Handles tickets, product uploads, reporting
Month 13	Developer / designer	Part-time contractor	Doubles build capacity
Month 25	Junior full-stack developer	Full-time	Owns platform features and client builds
Month 25	Paid ads & email specialist	Full-time or contract	Delivers Growth and Scale plan marketing
Year 3+	Sales & account manager	Full-time	Frees founder for strategy and partnerships

Organization chart (Year 3 target)

Founder / CEO Mike Haddon		
Development Jr. Full-Stack Dev Freelance designers	Marketing Services Ads & Email Specialist Freelance copy/photo	Client Success Support / VA (Account Mgr. later)

Advisors & professional services

The following advisors will be engaged before the first client launch:

- **CPA / bookkeeper:** entity setup, sales-tax guidance and quarterly estimated taxes.
- **Attorney:** client master services agreement, SOW templates, privacy policy and terms of service.
- **Business mentor:** through the Tyler-area Small Business Development Center (SBDC) and SCORE, both free.
- **Insurance agent:** general liability, professional liability (errors & omissions) and cyber coverage.

PART II

The Marketing Plan

How we build our own brand, reach the right owners, turn them into clients and keep them for years.

HOW WE WANT TO BE KNOWN

13. Brand Positioning & Messaging

Positioning statement

For small-business owners and new online sellers who want a real brand but don't have time to build it, Skelli-Sites is the done-for-you eCommerce partner that designs, launches and grows a custom store, unlike DIY platforms that leave the work to you or agencies that price you out.

Brand promise

"We build it. We run it. You sell."

Brand voice

We are...	We are not...
Friendly, plain-spoken, confident	Jargon-heavy or salesy
Practical: show real numbers and real stores	Hype: "get rich with dropshipping"
Local and personal: "your developer down the road"	A faceless agency

Key messages by segment

Segment	Headline message	Proof points
Local small business	"Your store, online in 30 days. Built by a Tyler local."	In-person meetings; local case studies; one monthly bill
Dropshipper	"Stop running a generic store. Launch a brand people trust."	Brand kit included; conversion-focused design; ads handled
Growing brand	"Outgrown Etsy? Own your channel and keep your margins."	Custom features; migration service; no marketplace fees
Nonprofits / churches	"Take donations and sell merch in one simple site."	Donation products built in; card and PayPal

PRODUCT, PRICE, PLACE, PROMOTION

14. Marketing Mix (4 Ps)

P	Strategy
Product	Done-for-you branded store on our own platform; 3 implementation packages, 3 monthly plans and add-ons (Section 7).
Price	Implementation \$1,500 / \$3,500 / \$6,500+; monthly \$149 / \$399 / \$899. Middle options anchored as "recommended." Founding-client discount for the first 5.
Place	Direct sales only: in person in Tyler and East Texas, plus video calls nationally. The marketing website is the main hub: portfolio, pricing, booking.
Promotion	Year 1: networking, referrals, local SEO and content, then paid ads as case studies build up. Detail in Sections 15 and 16.

Our own marketing website

Our own site (a separate marketing site, ideally built on the platform to show what it can do) needs: a homepage with a clear offer, portfolio and demo stores, pricing, a "Book a free consultation" calendar, a blog, lead magnets and testimonials. We should build **2 or 3 demo stores** (e.g., a boutique, a dropship niche store and a nonprofit store) before launch so prospects can click through a real store.

LAUNCH PHASES

15. Go-To-Market Strategy

Phase	Timing	Goals	Key actions
0. Pre-launch	Oct 2026	Brand identity final; site and demos live; 20 warm leads	Finalize logo and brand; form LLC; build marketing site and 2 or 3 demo stores; set up Google Business Profile; list 50 local prospects; tell your network
1. Founding clients	Nov 2026 to Jan 2027	5 founding clients; 3 case studies	30% founding discount; personal outreach; Chamber events; free "Is your business ready to sell online?" audits
2. Local growth	Feb to Jun 2027	2 new clients/month; referral engine running	Referral program; SBDC and partner workshops; local SEO; start Meta and Google ads with a small budget
3. National dropshipper push	Jul to Oct 2027	3+ clients/month; 30%+ from outside Tyler	Short-form video content; YouTube tutorials; dropshipping communities; before/after store makeovers
4. Scale	Year 2+	4 to 5 clients/month; MRR over \$15k	Hire support and ads help; case-study-driven ads; agency and reseller partnerships

WHERE THE CLIENTS COME FROM

16. Marketing Channels & Tactics

Channel	Tactics	Primary segment	Priority
Networking & in-person	Tyler Area Chamber, BNI-style referral groups, SBDC workshops, farmers and makers markets, downtown merchant groups	Local	High (Y1)
Referral program	\$150 credit or cash per referred client who signs; partner referral fee for CPAs, photographers and bankers	All	High
Local SEO	Google Business Profile, reviews, pages such as "ecommerce website design Tyler TX", local directory citations	Local	High
Content marketing / blog	Guides: "How to start dropshipping the right way," "Shopify vs. custom store," case studies	All	Medium
YouTube & short-form video	Build-in-public, store makeovers, 60-second eCommerce tips on TikTok, Reels and Shorts	Dropshippers	Medium to High (Y1 H2)
Social media	Facebook (local groups, business page), Instagram (portfolio), LinkedIn (founder story)	Local / growing	Medium
Communities	Reddit (r/dropship, r/ecommerce, r/smallbusiness), Discord and Facebook groups: give genuine help, no spam	Dropshippers	Medium
Paid search (Google)	High-intent keywords; start with \$200 to \$300/mo, target cost per lead under \$60	All	Medium (from Month 4)
Paid social (Meta)	Lead ads to East Texas business owners; retarget site visitors; case-study creatives	Local / dropship	Medium (from Month 4)
Email marketing	Lead magnet: "Brand Launch Checklist"; monthly newsletter; nurture sequence for consultation no-shows	All	Medium
Influencers & partners	Collaborate with small eCommerce YouTubers and creators; guest on local podcasts and radio	Dropshippers	Low to Medium
Print & direct mail	Postcards and leave-behind one-pagers for downtown and Broadway Ave retailers	Local	Low

FROM STRANGER TO ADVOCATE

17. Sales Funnel & Customer Journey

AWARENESS	Sees a video, post, ad, Google result or meets founder at an event	Reach, impressions, site visitors
INTEREST	Visits site, browses demo stores, downloads checklist	Leads captured (goal: 3% of visitors)
CONSULTATION	Books a free 30-minute discovery call or free store audit	Calls booked (goal: 25% of leads)
PROPOSAL	Receives a tailored proposal within 48 hours	Proposals sent
CLIENT	Signs SOW, pays 50% deposit	Close rate (goal: 35 to 40% of calls)
RETENTION	Launch, monthly plan, reports, quarterly reviews	Churn under 3%/mo; upgrade rate
ADVOCACY	Leaves a review, refers a friend, becomes a case study	Referrals per client; review count

Funnel math: what it takes to hit the Year 1 targets

At a 3% visitor-to-lead rate, a 25% lead-to-call rate and a 35% close rate, each new client takes about **3 discovery calls, 11 to 12 leads and roughly 400 site visitors**. At the Year 1 exit pace of 3 to 4 clients a month, that is about **10 to 12 calls, 45 leads and 1,500 visitors a month**. In Year 1, in-person referrals will close far better than these online averages.

KEEP AND GROW EVERY CLIENT

18. Customer Retention Strategy

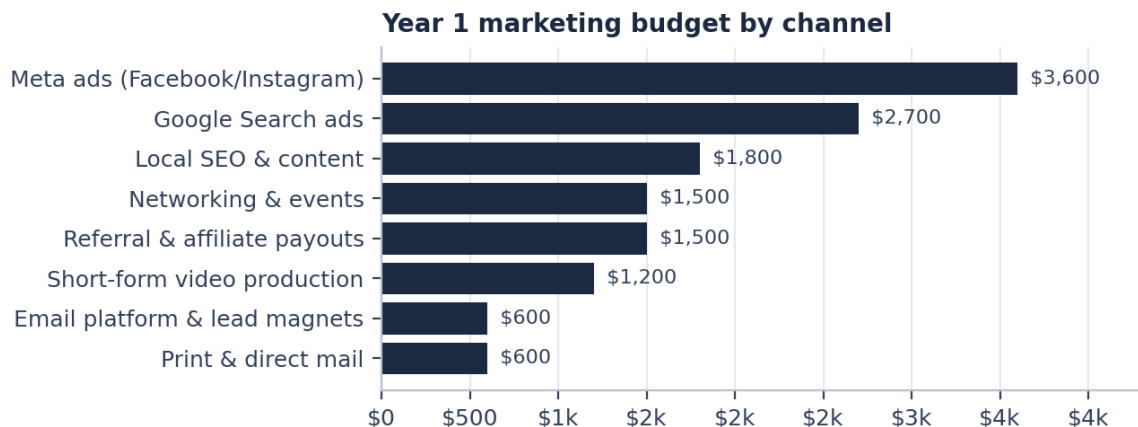
Moment	What we do
Day 0: Welcome	Welcome email and video, onboarding form, shared project board, clear timeline
Launch day	Launch celebration post featuring the client, first-order alert, recorded admin training
Day 30	Check-in call: what's working, early sales review, fix any friction
Monthly	Plain-English report: traffic, sales, conversion rate, ad results, next month's plan
Quarterly	Growth review: recommend upgrades (Care to Growth to Scale), seasonal campaigns, new features
Anniversary	Brand refresh check, thank-you gift, ask for a review and referral
At-risk signals	Declining logins or sales, late payments, support frustration: founder calls personally within 48 hours

- **Loyalty:** after 12 months on a plan, clients get one free feature or design refresh (up to 5 hours).
- **Upsells:** ad management, BNPL, email flows, photography, second storefront or wholesale portal.
- **Switching cost through value, not lock-in:** clients can always export their data and domain. We keep them by producing results.

YEAR 1 SPEND

19. Marketing Budget

Channel	Year 1 budget	Purpose
Meta ads (Facebook/Instagram)	\$3,600	Retargeting + lead ads to East Texas owners and US dropshippers
Google Search ads	\$2,700	High-intent keywords: 'ecommerce website design Tyler TX', 'dropshipping store setup'
Local SEO & content	\$1,800	Google Business Profile, blog posts, case studies, backlinks
Networking & events	\$1,500	Chamber events, BNI-style groups, pop-up markets, workshops
Referral & affiliate payouts	\$1,500	\$150 credit per referred client who signs
Short-form video production	\$1,200	TikTok/Reels/YouTube Shorts: build-in-public and before/after
Email platform & lead magnets	\$600	Newsletter, free 'Brand Launch Checklist' download
Print & direct mail	\$600	Postcards and leave-behinds for Tyler-area retailers
Total	\$13,500	~\$1,125/mo average (\$750/mo for months 1 to 3, \$1,250/mo after)



Marketing grows to \$36,000 in Year 2 and \$60,000 in Year 3, shifting toward paid ads and video once case studies prove what converts. Rule of thumb: keep marketing at 5% to 10% of revenue, and cut any channel that can't show a cost per client under \$900 after 90 days.

WHAT WE MEASURE

20. KPIs & Metrics

Category	KPI	Year 1 target	Review
Traffic	Marketing-site visitors / month	1,500 by Month 12	Weekly
Leads	New leads / month; visitor-to-lead rate	45 / 3%	Weekly
Sales	Discovery calls; close rate	10 to 12 per month; 35%+	Weekly
Sales	New clients / month	3 by Month 9 (24 for the year)	Monthly
Revenue	Monthly recurring revenue (MRR)	\$7,677 by Month 12	Monthly
Revenue	Average implementation fee	\$2,950+	Monthly
Retention	Monthly client churn	Under 3%	Monthly
Retention	Net Promoter Score (NPS)	50+	Quarterly
Efficiency	Customer acquisition cost (CAC)	Under \$900	Monthly
Efficiency	LTV : CAC	3 : 1 or better	Quarterly
Delivery	Days from deposit to launch (Brand package)	28 days or less	Per project
Client results	Client store conversion rate	1.5% to 3%	Monthly
Platform	Uptime	99.9%	Monthly

NOV 2026 TO OCT 2027

21. 12-Month Marketing Calendar

Month	Theme / focus	Key activities
Nov 2026	Founding clients	Launch site and demos; announce founding-client offer; Chamber mixer; start blog (2 posts/mo)
Dec 2026	Holiday rush help	"Last-minute holiday storefront" mini-offer; gift-shop outreach; publish first case study
Jan 2027	New Year, new business	"Launch your brand in 2027" webinar; target New Year dropshipper searches; start email newsletter
Feb 2027	Referral engine	Launch referral program; partner outreach to CPAs, bankers and photographers; SBDC workshop
Mar 2027	Tax-refund season	Start Google and Meta ads; promote Launch package to dropshippers
Apr 2027	Tyler spring events	Booths at local markets and events (e.g., Azalea & Spring Flower Trail season); free store audits
May 2027	Case studies	3 client spotlight videos; submit to local media and business journal
Jun 2027	Video push	Start weekly short-form video schedule; YouTube "store makeover" series
Jul 2027	National dropshippers	Community engagement (Reddit, Discord); guest on eCommerce podcasts
Aug 2027	Q4 prep	"Get holiday-ready by October" campaign; push Growth and Scale upgrades to existing clients
Sep 2027	Holiday build deadline	Last call for holiday launches; retargeting ads; email sequence
Oct 2027	Rose Festival & 1-year review	Texas Rose Festival local tie-in; year-one recap post; plan Year 2 budget

PART III

The Financial Plan

Startup costs, three-year projections in three scenarios, cash flow, break-even and funding.
All figures are modeled estimates.

WHAT IT TAKES TO OPEN THE DOORS

22. Startup Costs

Item	Est. cost
Texas LLC Certificate of Formation (SOS filing)	\$300
Assumed name (DBA) certificate, if brand differs from LLC name	\$25
Registered agent (1 yr, optional)	\$125
Domain names + business email (1 yr)	\$150
Brand identity: logo, colors, brand guide (freelancer)	\$750
Contract templates: MSA, SOW, privacy/terms (attorney review)	\$750
Business insurance, first quarter deposit	\$300
Production AWS setup, SSL, monitoring (first 3 months)	\$450
Software subscriptions (first 3 months)	\$600
Launch marketing: portfolio site, demo stores, printed materials	\$1,500
Networking: Tyler Area Chamber membership + events	\$500
Contingency (~10%)	\$550
Total startup costs	\$6,000

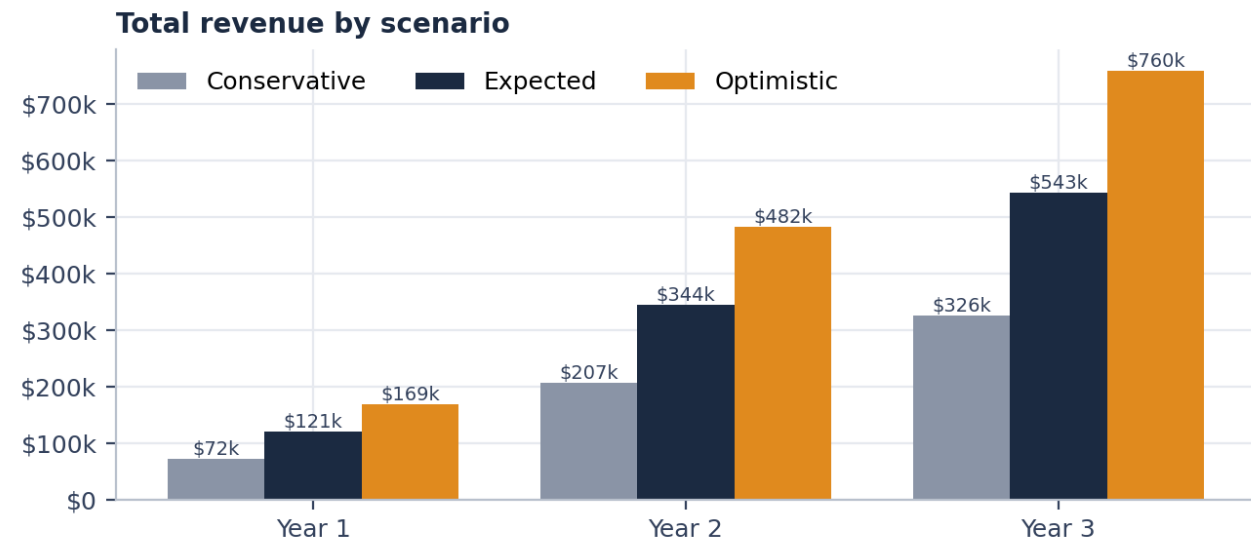
Already covered by the founder (sweat equity): platform development to date, development computer and software. Building a comparable platform would cost a client thousands of dollars at typical contractor rates, so the existing codebase is a significant in-kind contribution by the founder.

Starting capital: \$10,000 owner contribution = \$6,000 startup costs + \$4,000 operating reserve.

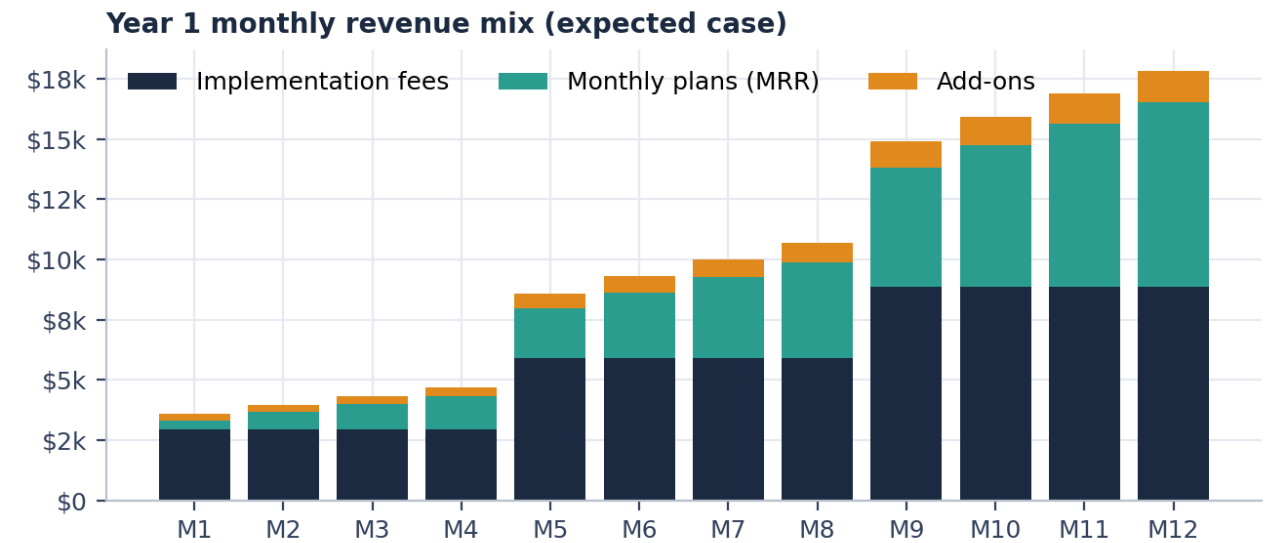
THREE YEARS, THREE SCENARIOS

23. Revenue Projections

Key assumptions (expected case): clients launched per month grow from 1 to 3 in Year 1 (24 total), then 4/month in Year 2 and 5/month in Year 3. Average implementation fee \$2,950; average monthly plan \$362; 3% monthly churn; add-ons equal 8% of core revenue. Conservative = 60% of expected client volume; optimistic = 140%. Staffing costs scale with volume in each scenario.



Scenario	Year 1	Year 2	Year 3	Active clients, end Y3	MRR, end Y3
Conservative	\$72,425	\$206,623	\$325,548	54	\$19,429
Expected	\$120,708	\$344,371	\$542,580	90	\$32,381
Optimistic	\$168,991	\$482,119	\$759,613	125	\$45,333



Year 1 monthly detail (expected case)

	M1	M2	M3	M4	M5	M6	M7	M8	M9	M10	M11	M12	Y1
New clients	1	1	1	1	2	2	2	2	3	3	3	3	24
Active clients	1.0	2.0	2.9	3.8	5.7	7.5	9.3	11.0	13.7	16.3	18.8	21.2	21.2
Implementation	3.0	3.0	3.0	3.0	5.9	5.9	5.9	5.9	8.8	8.8	8.8	8.8	70.8
Monthly plans	0.4	0.7	1.1	1.4	2.1	2.7	3.4	4.0	5.0	5.9	6.8	7.7	41.0
Add-ons	0.3	0.3	0.3	0.3	0.6	0.7	0.7	0.8	1.1	1.2	1.3	1.3	8.9
Total revenue	3.6	4.0	4.3	4.7	8.6	9.3	10.0	10.7	14.9	15.9	16.9	17.8	120.7
Total costs	2.2	2.2	2.3	2.8	3.7	3.8	5.9	5.9	6.9	7.0	7.1	7.2	56.8
Net income	1.4	1.7	2.1	1.9	4.9	5.5	4.2	4.8	8.0	8.9	9.8	10.7	63.9

Dollar figures in thousands. Fractional client counts come from modeling churn as an average.

EXPECTED CASE, PRE-TAX

24. Projected Profit & Loss Statement

	Year 1	Year 2	Year 3
Implementation fees	\$70,800	\$141,600	\$177,000
Monthly plan revenue	\$40,967	\$177,262	\$325,389
Add-on services	\$8,941	\$25,509	\$40,191
Total revenue	\$120,708	\$344,371	\$542,580
Cost of revenue (hosting, contractors, processing)	(\$24,721)	(\$60,442)	(\$87,531)
Gross profit	\$95,987	\$283,929	\$455,050
Gross margin	80%	82%	84%
Software & tools	(\$2,400)	(\$4,200)	(\$6,000)
Insurance	(\$1,200)	(\$1,500)	(\$2,100)
Accounting & legal	(\$1,800)	(\$3,000)	(\$4,200)
Phone & internet	(\$1,200)	(\$1,200)	(\$1,200)
Marketing	(\$13,500)	(\$36,000)	(\$60,000)
Owner's draw	(\$12,000)	(\$60,000)	(\$84,000)
Staff & contractors	\$0	(\$54,000)	(\$162,000)
Office / coworking	\$0	\$0	(\$4,800)
Total operating expenses	(\$32,100)	(\$159,900)	(\$324,300)
Net income (pre-tax)	\$63,887	\$124,029	\$130,750
Net margin	53%	36%	24%

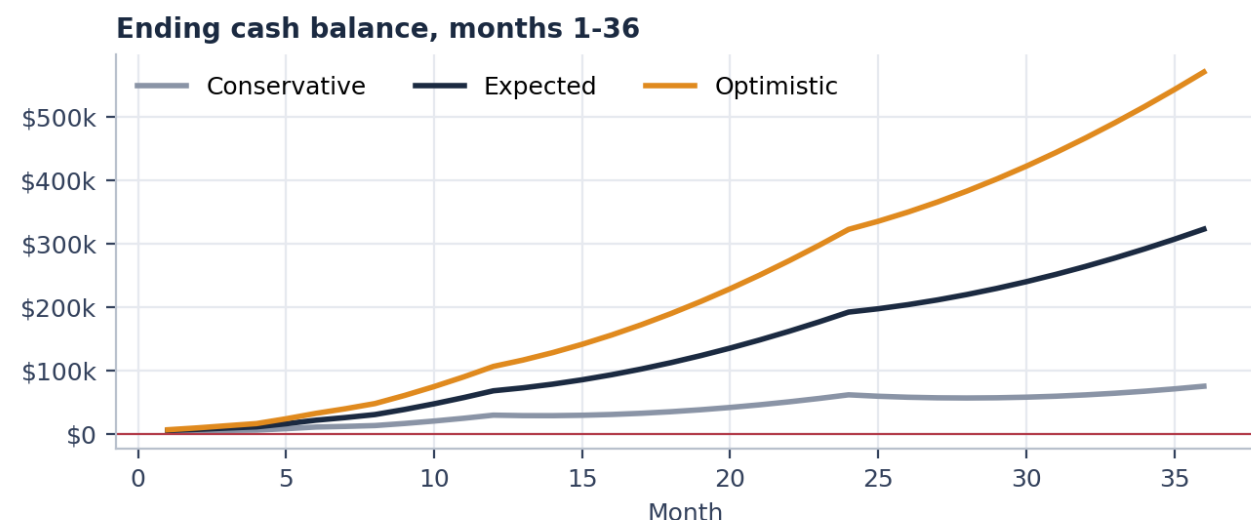
TAX NOTE: Owner's draw is shown as an operating expense so profit reflects a real founder salary. For an LLC taxed as a sole proprietorship, the owner pays self-employment and federal income tax on net profit plus draws. Set aside ~25% to 30% and pay quarterly estimates. Texas has no state income tax. Taxes are not modeled here.

Net income by scenario

Scenario	Year 1	Year 2	Year 3
Conservative	\$25,492	\$32,058	\$13,530
Expected	\$63,887	\$124,029	\$130,750
Optimistic	\$102,282	\$216,001	\$247,970

STAYING SOLVENT

25. Cash Flow Projection



	Year 1	Year 2	Year 3
Beginning cash	\$10,000	\$67,887	\$191,917
Less: startup costs	(\$6,000)	—	—
Cash in: client revenue	\$120,708	\$344,371	\$542,580
Cash out: cost of revenue	(\$24,721)	(\$60,442)	(\$87,531)
Cash out: operating expenses (incl. owner's draw)	(\$32,100)	(\$159,900)	(\$324,300)
Net cash flow from operations	\$63,887	\$124,029	\$130,750
Ending cash (pre-tax)	\$67,887	\$191,917	\$322,666

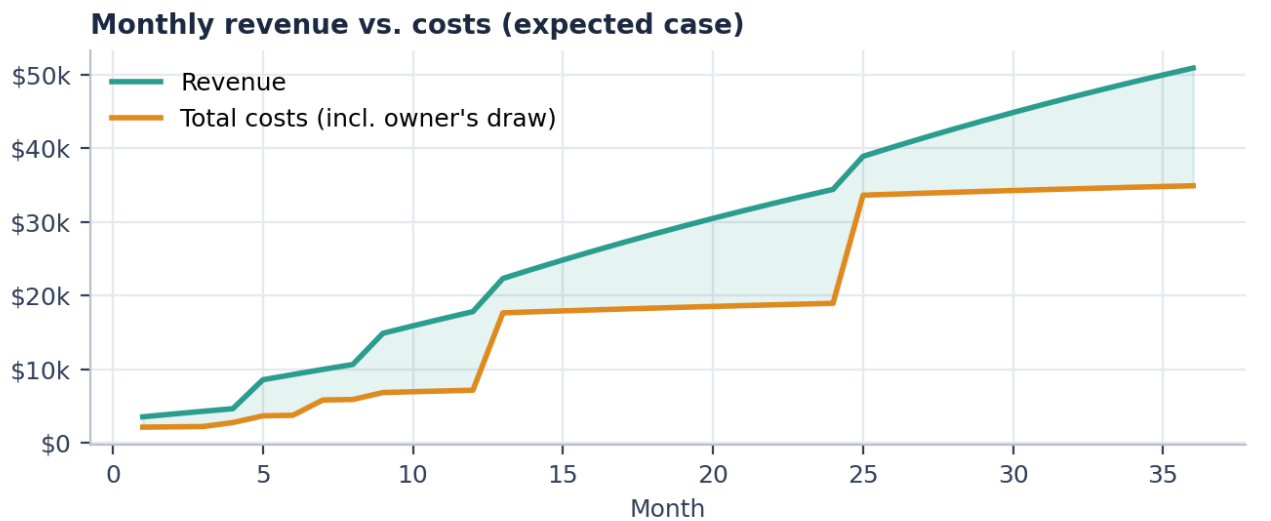
Cash stays positive in every month of all three scenarios; the lowest point in the conservative case is \$4,321. The 50% implementation deposit is the main cash-flow protection: build costs are covered before work starts.

Cash management policies

- Keep a reserve of at least **3 months of fixed expenses** before each new hire.
- Collect implementation fees 50/50; monthly plans auto-billed on the 1st by card on file; late accounts paused after 15 days.
- Move 25% to 30% of profit into a separate tax savings account every month.
- Surplus cash beyond the reserve goes to (1) marketing that is proven to work, then (2) the multi-tenant platform rebuild.

WHEN THE BUSINESS PAYS FOR ITSELF

26. Break-Even Analysis



Break-even measure	Result (expected case)
First month with positive net income (after owner's draw)	Month 1
Average fixed costs, months 7 to 12 (incl. \$2,000 owner's draw)	\$3,800 / month
Contribution per client from monthly plan	\$321 / month
Active clients needed for recurring revenue alone to cover fixed costs	~12 clients
Month the expected case reaches that many active clients	Month 9
Startup capital recovered (cumulative cash above starting contribution)	Month 4

Year 3 hiring pushes the fixed cost base up sharply, so recurring revenue alone does not cover *all* costs again until about Month 34. That is by design: implementation fees fund the new team while the client base grows.

The goal to watch is **recurring break-even**: the point where monthly plans alone pay all fixed costs. After that, every implementation fee is profit that can fund growth, and a slow sales month no longer threatens the business.

SELF-FUNDED, WITH OPTIONAL GROWTH CAPITAL

27. Funding Request & Use of Funds

Current plan: self-funded. The founder contributes \$10,000. The model shows the business can fund itself from Month 1, so no outside capital is *required*.

Optional growth capital: \$25,000 to \$50,000, raised only if early results beat the expected case and demand outruns capacity. Possible sources:

- SBA Microloan (up to \$50,000) through an intermediary lender serving East Texas
- Local bank or credit union small-business line of credit
- Texas and local small-business grants or pitch competitions; SBDC guidance on options
- Friends-and-family or angel investment (SAFE or convertible note)

Use of funds (if raised: \$40,000 example)	Amount	Impact
Hire part-time developer/designer 6 months early	\$18,000	Doubles build capacity in Year 1
Paid ads and video content	\$10,000	Faster national dropshipper acquisition
Multi-tenant platform rebuild and automation	\$7,000	Cuts per-client setup time and hosting cost
Working-capital reserve	\$5,000	Protects against slow months

PART IV

Risk & Execution

What could go wrong, how we'll respond, and the milestones that keep the plan on track.

PLANNING FOR WHAT COULD GO WRONG

28. Risk Assessment & Mitigation

Risk	Likelihood	Impact	Mitigation
Founder capacity / key-person risk	High	High	Documented processes; freelance bench; scripted deployments; hire support in Year 2; disability insurance
Slow client acquisition	Medium	High	Low fixed costs; founding-client offer; referral program; weekly funnel review; adjust pricing
Security breach or data loss	Low to Medium	High	Tokenized payments (Square/PayPal); HTTPS; bcrypt; least-privilege admin; daily backups; dependency updates; cyber insurance
Platform bugs / outages	Medium	Medium	Automated tests, staging environments, uptime monitoring, incident response plan, status page
Payment or ad-platform policy changes	Medium	Medium	Support multiple processors; clients own their merchant and ad accounts
Dropship supplier problems (delays, quality)	Medium	Medium	Vet suppliers; favor U.S. warehouses; clear shipping-time disclosures; client education
Competition from AI and DIY builders	High	Medium	Compete on brand, service and results rather than tools; use AI internally to deliver faster
Client disputes / scope creep	Medium	Low to Medium	Clear SOWs, change-order process, revision limits, attorney-reviewed contract
Economic downturn	Medium	Medium	Recurring revenue base; lower-price Launch tier; focus on ROI messaging

Regulatory & compliance checklist

Area	Requirement	Action
Business formation	Texas LLC; Assumed Name Certificate if applicable; EIN	File with Texas SOS; get EIN free from the IRS
Texas sales tax	Texas generally taxes data processing services (which can include hosting and SaaS) on 80% of the charge; treatment of web design varies	Get a sales-tax permit if required; have a CPA review the pricing structure
Texas franchise tax	LLCs file annual reports; no tax due below the revenue threshold	Calendar the annual filing
PCI DSS	Card data security	Keep card data tokenized via Square and PayPal (SAQ-A style); never store raw card numbers
Privacy	Privacy policy; Texas Data Privacy and Security Act (TDPSA) obligations; consent for tracking	Template privacy policy and terms for every client store
FTC: online sales	Mail, Internet, or Telephone Order Merchandise Rule (ship on time or notify); truthful ads; endorsement and review rules	Shipping-time disclosures on dropship stores; no fake reviews
Email / SMS	CAN-SPAM (email); TCPA (texts need consent)	Double opt-in; unsubscribe links; SMS consent capture

Area	Requirement	Action
Accessibility	ADA website accessibility risk	Build to WCAG 2.1 AA; accessibility review before launch

DISCLAIMER: This checklist is general information, not legal or tax advice. Confirm each item with a Texas CPA and attorney.

THE NEXT 24 MONTHS

29. Milestones & Timeline

Target date	Milestone	Owner	Success measure
Oct 2026	Finalize Skelli-Sites logo and brand; form LLC; EIN; business bank account	Founder	Registered and banking
Oct 2026	Platform production-ready: HTTPS, production payment keys, cart fix, assets	Founder	All launch-blocking issues closed
Oct 2026	Marketing site + 2 or 3 demo stores live	Founder	Site live; demos clickable
Nov 2026	First paying client signed	Founder	Deposit received
Jan 2027	5 founding clients launched; 3 case studies	Founder	Testimonials published
Mar 2027	Paid ads and referral program running	Founder	Cost per lead under \$60
Apr 2027	Shipping integration, reviews, order emails, account page	Founder	Released to all clients
Jun 2027	Scripted per-client deployment	Founder	New store set up in under 1 hour
Oct 2027	Year 1 complete: ~24 clients, ~\$7,677 MRR	Founder	Matches expected case
Nov 2027	First contractors hired (support + dev/design)	Founder	Capacity of 4+ clients/month
Apr 2028	Multi-tenant architecture beta	Founder + dev	Hosting cost per client down 30%+
Oct 2028	Year 2 complete: ~56 active clients, ~\$20,084 MRR	Team	Monthly plans cover all fixed costs

WHERE THIS GOES

30. Exit Strategy & Long-Term Vision

Long-term vision (3 to 5 years)

- The leading eCommerce launch partner in East Texas, with 100+ active client stores.
- A productized platform: multi-tenant, with a template marketplace and a lower-cost self-serve tier alongside done-for-you service.
- A reseller and white-label program so other agencies and freelancers can build on our platform.

Exit options

Option	Description	What increases value
Lifestyle business	Keep ownership; founder draws a healthy salary; the team runs delivery	High recurring revenue, low churn, documented processes
Acquisition by an agency	Regional or national digital agency buys the client book and platform	MRR, client contracts, clean financials
Acquisition by a SaaS / eCommerce company	Platform and client base bought as a product line	Multi-tenant platform, growth rate, IP ownership
Management buyout	Key employees buy the business over time	Strong second-in-command; stable margins

Service businesses with recurring revenue commonly sell for a multiple of annual recurring revenue or seller's discretionary earnings. Building MRR, keeping churn low and owning the platform IP are the biggest drivers of value.

Appendix

A. Glossary

Term	Meaning
ARPA	Average revenue per account: average monthly plan fee per client
BNPL	Buy now, pay later (Klarna, Afterpay)
CAC	Customer acquisition cost: marketing and sales spend per new client
Churn	Share of clients who cancel in a period
Dropshipping	Selling products that a supplier ships directly to the customer; the seller holds no inventory
LTV	Lifetime value: total gross profit expected from one client
MRR	Monthly recurring revenue from monthly plans
Multi-tenant	One software installation serving many client stores, each with separate data
NPS	Net Promoter Score: how likely clients are to recommend us (-100 to 100)
PCI DSS	Security standard for handling payment-card data
SOW	Statement of work: defines scope, price and timeline for a project
TAM / SAM / SOM	Total, serviceable and obtainable market

B. Financial model assumptions

Assumption	Value	Source / rationale
Implementation package mix	50% / 35% / 15%	Founder estimate; dropshippers skew toward Launch
Monthly plan mix	45% / 40% / 15%	Founder estimate; most clients start on Care or Growth
New clients, Year 1	1 per month rising to 3 (24 total)	Solo founder capacity (about 3 to 4 builds/month)
New clients, Years 2 / 3	4 / 5 per month	Contractors added in Year 2; full-time hires in Year 3
Monthly churn	3%	Typical for small-business service retainers (2% to 5%)
Hosting and tools per client	\$30/month	AWS instance/database share, backups, email service; falls with multi-tenancy
Contractor costs	25% of implementation fees	Design, copy and photography freelancers
Card processing	3% of revenue	Typical card processing rates
Add-on services	8% of core revenue	Photography, extra products, custom work
Owner's draw	\$0 (M1 to 6), \$2k/mo (M7 to 12), \$5k/mo (Y2), \$7k/mo (Y3)	Founder plan

Assumption	Value	Source / rationale
Year 1 start	November 2026	Platform production-ready by late Oct 2026

C. Brand identity

Element	Detail
Company name	Skelli-Sites (register as Skelli-Sites LLC)
Primary tagline	"Your brand, built to sell."
Brand promise	"We build it. We run it. You sell."
Campaign taglines	"Good bones for your business." · "Strong bones. Standout brands." · "East Texas-built stores, selling everywhere."
Color palette	Navy #1B2A41 (trust, stability), Amber #E08A1E (energy, action), Teal #2A9D8F (growth)
Typography	Georgia for headlines; Segoe UI for body text
Pre-launch checks	Texas SOS name availability, domain (e.g., skelli-sites.com), USPTO trademark search, social handles

D. Sources

- U.S. Census Bureau, *Quarterly Retail E-Commerce Sales, 2nd Quarter 2026* (census.gov/retail/ecommerce.html).
- U.S. Small Business Administration, Office of Advocacy, *2025 Small Business Profiles and Frequently Asked Questions About Small Business 2026* (advocacy.sba.gov).
- Federal Reserve Bank of St. Louis (FRED), Resident Population in Tyler, TX (MSA).
- Tyler Economic Development Council, Demographics (tedc.org).
- Shopify published pricing, September 2026 (shopify.com/pricing).
- Texas Secretary of State, Form 205 Certificate of Formation filing fee; Texas Comptroller guidance on data processing services and franchise tax (sos.state.tx.us; comptroller.texas.gov).
- Internal: Skelli-Sites platform source code and three-year financial model.